

Digit Forum

Subject **Whats my wish-list**

vinitg
Analogue Novice
Location: Mumbai

Hi guys,
This is my first topic as I am new to the forum (needless to say completely hooked). I am a gadget freak with a never ending wishlist. Just yesterday, I read about the new digital cameras launched by all major companies. But not even one of them featured Bluetooth. Now if only digital cameras had Bluetooth, it would be so easy to transfer pix. So rite now I would love if some company (Sony?) came up with Bluetooth digicams.

krazydude
In-House Geek
Location: Follow me and I shall set u free

I wish for a mobile phone on which my friend and I can play DOOM 3 multiplayer at 1024 x 768 with all the eye candy.

gxsaarav
Digitized!
Location: Lucknow

Publicly, I wish for peace on Earth.
In actuality, here's the list:
AthlonFX 55, 2 GB Kingston DDR1, 6800 Ultra, a Zalman reserator with GPU Block, a Ducati S400, an nForce 4, 10 MBPS VDSL, a 20-inch Dell 2001FP, a 76 GB Raptor, a PS3, an MS Optical Desktop Comfort edition and a job as the Marketing Manager for nVidia in India.

plasmafire
Warmed-Up Nerd
No 12 will be hell 4 u.. I'm dead serious.
I called up the guy's office. So I know.
I also believe u r missing out a speaker system.

I wish for a Powermac G5 running Half-Life 2 and a Microsoft OS that never crashes.

techno_funky
Digitized Spammer
Location: Mumbai

A Swatch (still using a Timex) | AthlonFX 55 | Ferrari F430 | A job at Nasscom | A Bajaj Pulsar (as of now) | Sony Ericsson P900 | PS3 | a T1 Net connection | Creative THX S750 7.1 speakers | Creative Sound Blaster Audigy 2 ZS Platinum Pro Sound Card | To become a DJ

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Smart Cards, Smarter Bar Codes

Sachin Kalbag's editorial on the incorrect use of smart cards was enlightening. The purpose of a toll booth is to collect toll on a monthly basis from regular users and spot toll from casual users.

The sticker he referred to was for the monthly user, the purpose being to identify the vehicles who have paid for the month.

A simpler solution would be to print a sticker with a bar code. As soon as the vehicle approaches the toll booth, the attendant with a simple bar-code scanner scans the barcode into the PC, the PC would authenticate and if the vehicle has paid for the month a green light would light up, else a red one would light up along with an audible beep, and the gate at the far end would not open.

For this new regime, only a new bar code sticker would be required instead of



the expensive smart card. Even if this bar code sticker is lost, stolen or damaged, a new one could be issued at a ridiculously low price of less than a rupee.

This simple solution costs far less than a smart card-based solution, and it is much faster. There is no need of a "dog tag" and it is simpler to implement.

Apart from providing another unique Identity Code to each vehicle (first on being the registration number), which is also not needed, I see no purpose of using smart cards in toll booth kind of usage.

Sanjeev Mehta,
New Delhi

Phone Moan

Many people wonder why Internet services in India are most hated. I used to wonder, too. Until I found out for myself a few weeks ago. I have an MTNL Internet account. I could not get past the login screen. I called the MTNL Internet Services Hotline. Here is what happened:

The person who picked up the phone (let's call him A) told me to check the number of the error. I did so and called back, only to find a different person (let's call him B) on the line.

I had to explain my problem all over again. This person told me to dial a different number and find the duration for which I can hear a fax tone. I did so and called back. This time A picked up the phone. I disregarded the fax line report and told him the number of my error. He told me to dial MTNL's phone line number.

I called that number only to find that it was not in use! So I dialed the Hotline again; now B picked up the phone. So I gave him the duration of the fax tone. He asked me to dial the same number which A had given. I told him the number was not in use. He asked me to find the number MTNL's phone service to ask them to repair my line as he felt the problem was in my phone line, and not the Internet connection.

Three days, and numerous attempts later, I found the 'working' number for MTNL's local phone service in my part of Delhi, only to find that my phone line was perfectly ok! So I dialed the Hotline again, and a third person picked up the phone.

With a sinking heart I told him my problem all over again. This person, however, immediately gave me a new password and told me to try again. Miracle! It worked.

While I was happy to get my Net connection back, it was a harrowing five days for me. With such customer service, is it any wonder that MTNL complains of very few customers! Oh, and by the way, did I mention the slow speeds?

Amrit,
Delhi

I Won, Thanks To Digit

I am a computer applications student. I am not a subscriber, but I make sure I buy Digit every month. Some time ago, the institute where I study had a Digital Fest between four selected houses—Microsoft,